

Presentation Guide - Timestamped Transcript

Presentation Guide

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Timestamped transcript

- 00:00:01.300 --> 00:00:05.280 Hi, everybody. My name is Simon Matthews. I'm one of the tutors at the Language Centre,

- 00:00:05.300 --> 00:00:10.280 and I've put together this short video to give you some useful tips for when you're doing presentations.

- 00:00:12.340 --> 00:00:16.280 So presentations are often quite an important part of many courses,

- 00:00:16.300 --> 00:00:19.920 and some courses are also assessed, so it's important to get them right.

- 00:00:20.240 --> 00:00:25.140 So in this presentation, we're going to cover four aspects to help you during your presentation.

- 00:00:25.140 --> 00:00:29.460 We're also going to look quickly at some points to note when you're presenting remotely,

- 00:00:30.100 --> 00:00:33.820 and we'll finish up by looking at some useful resources for you.

- 00:00:34.580 --> 00:00:40.300 So first of all, let's look at voice. There are four considerations in this part which you need to be aware of.

- 00:00:40.460 --> 00:00:46.820 So the first one is related to speed. So presentations can be quite a nerve-wracking experience,

- 00:00:46.820 --> 00:00:52.280 and in many cases, this will cause your voice to go quicker than normal.

- 00:00:53.020 --> 00:00:58.720 So what you should do to avoid this is to practice as much as possible and try to regulate your speed.

- 00:00:59.900 --> 00:01:05.440 Related to this also is your volume. So it's important to speak at a good volume,

- 00:01:05.440 --> 00:01:09.300 especially for the room that you're in, not to be too soft or

too loud.

- 00:01:09.860 --> 00:01:15.020 If you get the chance, it can be helpful to go and visit the room where you're going to do your presentation,

- 00:01:15.020 --> 00:01:20.480 maybe with a couple of friends and just get them to sit around the room and tell you if they can hear you or not,

- 00:01:20.600 --> 00:01:22.320 and then make changes accordingly.

- 00:01:23.640 --> 00:01:26.400 The tone which you use in your presentation is important.

- 00:01:26.600 --> 00:01:29.420 So tone is about the rising and the falling of your voice.

- 00:01:30.040 --> 00:01:34.220 Basically, if you pay attention to your tone and you sound interested in what you're saying,

- 00:01:34.220 --> 00:01:37.300 it really helps the audience to get to grips with what you're talking about.

- 00:01:37.700 --> 00:01:42.380 If you sound like you're bored or if you're speaking very slowly and very flatly,

- 00:01:42.920 --> 00:01:46.540 it becomes very boring for the audience and then they stop listening to you.

- 00:01:46.620 --> 00:01:49.020 So it's really important to keep a note of that in your mind.

- 00:01:49.980 --> 00:01:53.260 The last point about your voice is hesitation.

- 00:01:53.720 --> 00:01:58.880 So it's quite normal to stop and think every so often about what's coming next.

- 00:01:59.040 --> 00:02:02.100 And it normally be accompanied by a noise like mmm or ahh.

- 00:02:02.460 --> 00:02:06.280 But if you can minimize these, that's always helpful.

- 00:02:06.740 --> 00:02:10.640 These often occur if you memorize your presentation.

- 00:02:10.640 --> 00:02:16.380 So if you've memorized a script, you'll quite often hesitate a lot as you try to recall the next part.

- 00:02:16.380 --> 00:02:19.940 And then if you forget the next part, you'll end up making a lot of these noises.

- 00:02:20.460 --> 00:02:25.460 So the best thing to do is just to practice as much as possible in order to limit the hesitations.

- 00:02:26.160 --> 00:02:30.700 On the day, if you do find yourself hesitating and making lots of these noises,

- 00:02:30.700 --> 00:02:35.580 it can be a good idea to just halt for a moment, take a deep breath and then continue.

- 00:02:37.780 --> 00:02:39.680 So over to body language.

- 00:02:40.140 --> 00:02:44.580 And the most important aspect of this, arguably, is your eye contact.

- 00:02:44.580 --> 00:02:47.820 So this means looking your audience in the eyes as you're talking.

- 00:02:48.380 --> 00:02:52.780 And this is important because if you are looking at somebody when you are speaking,

- 00:02:53.280 --> 00:02:55.740 you kind of feel like you're engaging with them.

- 00:02:55.860 --> 00:02:58.580 You're interacting with them and you relate to them more.

- 00:02:58.780 --> 00:02:59.700 So it's really important.

- 00:03:00.680 --> 00:03:04.540 Try not to focus on a specific person, for example, the tutor.

- 00:03:04.760 --> 00:03:06.580 Do try and give everybody some eye contact.

- 00:03:08.160 --> 00:03:18.040 And also, if you are a bit nervous about looking people in the eye, then a good tip is to maybe look at the end of their nose or their forehead or something like that,

- 00:03:18.160 --> 00:03:19.960 just so it looks like you're looking them in the eye.

- 00:03:20.340 --> 00:03:24.600 This makes you appear more confident and it really helps you to interact with your audience.

- 00:03:26.180 --> 00:03:28.540 The next point is about your hands.

- 00:03:29.420 --> 00:03:41.680 So many presenters or lecturers like to gesture, which means moving their hands towards their slides and their materials or just moving them around generally or using them to list points, things like this.

- 00:03:42.240 --> 00:03:47.540 And gesture is a good way to, you know, maintain interest in what you're doing, what you're talking about.

- 00:03:47.900 --> 00:03:53.860 And again, try not to use it too much, because if you're moving your hands constantly, it can look a bit like fidgeting.

- 00:03:54.320 --> 00:03:56.780 This means moving your hands for no purpose.
- 00:03:57.540 --> 00:04:01.720 So try to keep your hands active and not too active.
- 00:04:03.160 --> 00:04:08.800 Regarding the rest of your body, many lecturers or presenters also like to move around a little.
- 00:04:08.800 --> 00:04:13.260 So perhaps walk from one end of the room to the other or something like that.
- 00:04:13.560 --> 00:04:17.340 And this can be good to help maintain interest in what you're talking about.
- 00:04:17.520 --> 00:04:20.460 But again, try not to move around too much. That's distracting.
- 00:04:20.740 --> 00:04:27.860 And importantly, don't stand in front of your presentation, which can happen quite easily if you're not paying attention.
- 00:04:29.780 --> 00:04:36.020 Related to your stance, if you're standing still at any point, it's important to keep your hands.
- 00:04:36.020 --> 00:04:40.960 If you're not gesturing, just keep them folded either in front of you or behind your back.
- 00:04:41.140 --> 00:04:42.540 Don't put them in your pockets.
- 00:04:43.340 --> 00:04:48.500 And also try to avoid crossing your arms because this looks a bit defensive and unfriendly.
- 00:04:49.380 --> 00:04:51.800 And the last point about this is to smile.
- 00:04:51.800 --> 00:04:57.500 If you smile, your audience feels more comfortable with you and you also look more confident, like you're enjoying yourself.
- 00:04:57.500 --> 00:04:59.260 So it always works well in presentations.
- 00:05:01.540 --> 00:05:03.640 Moving now to your language.
- 00:05:04.880 --> 00:05:09.360 So one thing that people lose marks for in presentations is related to the pronunciation.
- 00:05:09.800 --> 00:05:12.820 And this isn't accents. This is about pronunciation.
- 00:05:12.820 --> 00:05:17.360 So do check out any key words you're going to be saying.
- 00:05:17.640 --> 00:05:22.600 So especially things like people's names or place names or theories or things like that.

- 00:05:22.840 --> 00:05:25.660 Anything which is important needs to be pronounced correctly.
- 00:05:25.660 --> 00:05:30.680 So do check with your classmates, your friends or also your language teacher as well, if you're not sure.
- 00:05:32.740 --> 00:05:34.880 Presentations do vary in their formality.
- 00:05:34.880 --> 00:05:45.580 So sometimes it'll be quite a small group presentation whereby you can be a bit less formal or sometimes it's, you know, quite large with many people watching you where you might want to be slightly more formal.
- 00:05:46.000 --> 00:05:53.780 You don't need to be as formal as your written assignment regarding the words that you use, but some degree of formality can often help.
- 00:05:54.100 --> 00:05:57.760 And basically whatever makes you feel more comfortable usually works.
- 00:05:59.840 --> 00:06:03.260 Vocabulary and grammar should be as clear as possible.
- 00:06:03.260 --> 00:06:11.400 So obviously it's good if you are able to use accurate grammar confidently, the more complex phrases.
- 00:06:11.960 --> 00:06:15.700 But if you're not comfortable with that, you can be a little bit more simple.
- 00:06:15.700 --> 00:06:19.780 But as long as you're clear and on message, that usually works well for presentations.
- 00:06:21.200 --> 00:06:26.020 Regarding your organization, there are three areas which can help you as well.
- 00:06:26.380 --> 00:06:28.520 So the first area is signposting.
- 00:06:29.240 --> 00:06:34.800 And so there are a number of semi fixed phrases which you can learn and which you can use.
- 00:06:35.080 --> 00:06:38.120 Do feel free to pause the video if you want to look at these in more depth.
- 00:06:38.520 --> 00:06:44.600 But basically these signposts, they tell the listener what's coming next and what's important.
- 00:06:44.640 --> 00:06:49.560 And also, you know, what you're going to talk about when you're going to finish these kinds of phrases.
- 00:06:49.560 --> 00:06:53.180 It's very useful because they give your audience a clear idea of where you're going.

- 00:06:56.060 --> 00:07:07.560 Equally, during your presentation, it's a good idea to use appropriately some linking words, which help to give the audience an idea of how your ideas fit together.

- 00:07:08.260 --> 00:07:14.060 You don't need to use these too often. For example, you don't need to begin every sentence with them.

- 00:07:14.160 --> 00:07:19.060 But it's good to have one or two just to help the audience get a clear idea of what you're talking about.

- 00:07:21.420 --> 00:07:32.300 Finally, just to add some experts, it's a good idea not to overlook adverbs because they're very useful, particularly highlighting key points or just adding interest to what you're saying.

- 00:07:32.300 --> 00:07:35.220 So try to have a few of those in there as well.

- 00:07:38.580 --> 00:07:45.800 The last point about presenting skills is related to your materials, which are going to help you to deliver your talk.

- 00:07:46.240 --> 00:07:52.640 So if you're going to be using slides of any sort, one thing to note is the colors that you're going to use.

- 00:07:52.820 --> 00:08:00.540 So sometimes certain colors, like in this example, are very difficult to see, particularly on a large screen or from far away.

- 00:08:01.360 --> 00:08:05.580 So do pay attention to that. So colors like yellow and white don't work either.

- 00:08:06.680 --> 00:08:10.800 Equally, your writing size. If your writing is too small, it's difficult to read.

- 00:08:11.100 --> 00:08:15.200 And the listener is trying to read them instead of listening to you.

- 00:08:16.480 --> 00:08:20.680 Try to make your slides as attractive as possible without being too distracting.

- 00:08:21.560 --> 00:08:25.660 It's always a good idea to try and get some feedback from a couple of friends to see what they think.

- 00:08:26.600 --> 00:08:30.080 And obviously slides should focus on key points only.

- 00:08:30.340 --> 00:08:34.800 So if you're writing down everything that you're going to say, this has two problems.

- 00:08:35.000 --> 00:08:38.340 One, you're going to read it because it's there.

- 00:08:38.900 --> 00:08:43.360 And another problem is your audience is going to read it as well and they're not going to listen to you.

- 00:08:43.420 --> 00:08:47.000 So that defeats the whole point of the presentation. So do stick to your key points.

- 00:08:48.160 --> 00:08:57.480 One important thing to note is if it's an academic presentation, which which it may well be, it's important to include a reference page as your last slide,

- 00:08:57.520 --> 00:09:02.660 which has your full references for any sources or information that you've used in your presentation.

- 00:09:06.080 --> 00:09:10.220 If you are having notes, some lectures do allow notes and some of them don't.

- 00:09:10.420 --> 00:09:17.460 But if you are allowed to have notes, it's a good idea to keep them as brief as possible, similar to your slides, key points only.

- 00:09:18.560 --> 00:09:25.720 And try to avoid writing a script because, again, you'll end up reading it, which means you lose your eye contact with your audience.

- 00:09:25.720 --> 00:09:32.120 So they stop listening to you. And again, it's going to affect your voice and you'll end up with that boring, flat monotone.

- 00:09:32.380 --> 00:09:35.480 So do try to use notes carefully, if at all.

- 00:09:38.460 --> 00:09:50.480 In these days, due to the Covid-19 situation, it's quite possible you may have to do some remote presentations and perhaps using Teams or some other software platform.

- 00:09:51.060 --> 00:09:55.640 In this case, it's always important to do a technology check beforehand.

- 00:09:56.240 --> 00:10:04.840 So check the video, your camera works, check your sound and your microphone works and also check that you have a secure and stable Internet connection.

- 00:10:05.900 --> 00:10:17.600 If possible, it might also be a good idea to keep a backup of your slides just so you can access them in case there's some kind of server issue and you can maybe pass them on to classmates or tutors as well.

- 00:10:17.600 --> 00:10:26.760 One way to do that is to save them as a PDF file and you can also keep a copy on a memory stick or something like that just in case.

- 00:10:28.600 --> 00:10:39.240 Also, if you are going to be appearing on your webcam, it's important that you look smart and professional or at least neat and tidy and do try to keep light sources in front of you.

- 00:10:39.240 --> 00:10:44.800 So if your room has a window, try to sit so you are facing the window, not so the windows behind you.

- 00:10:44.960 --> 00:10:49.120 If you do this, you'll just appear like a shadow, which is, you know, nobody can see your face.

- 00:10:49.240 --> 00:10:54.800 It's not very good for presenting. Try also to be aware of your background and your environment that you're in.

- 00:10:54.800 --> 00:10:59.440 So if you don't have an attractive background, a plain wall would be fine.

- 00:10:59.860 --> 00:11:06.360 And if you're using a software platform like Zoom, you can actually download backgrounds to make it more appropriate.

- 00:11:06.960 --> 00:11:13.840 And also consider your environment. So if it's in a noisy environment, try to move somewhere quieter or close the window or something like that.

- 00:11:15.220 --> 00:11:24.120 And related to the eye contact. So obviously, when you're video conferencing, you're going to see lots of images of the people in the same virtual space.

- 00:11:24.460 --> 00:11:27.060 And it's very tempting to look at those images.

- 00:11:27.320 --> 00:11:34.580 But what you should be doing is trying to look at the camera, which means that it looks like the audience is keeping eye contact with you.

- 00:11:35.220 --> 00:11:40.060 And to help with this, you could prop up your computer on a few books or something like that.

- 00:11:40.160 --> 00:11:46.700 So it's eye level. This will also help you to keep a straight back and to give your voice maximum impact as well.

- 00:11:49.840 --> 00:11:54.440 Here are a couple of resources that might help you when you're designing your presentations.

- 00:11:54.480 --> 00:11:58.960 So the first one here is Pretzi and I've used Pretzi for this presentation.

- 00:11:58.960 --> 00:12:01.660 So if you like that, then you can go and have a look.

- 00:12:02.220 --> 00:12:07.380 Pretzi is not a free service, but you do get several free templates to use.

- 00:12:07.920 --> 00:12:09.780 And you can also subscribe.

- 00:12:09.940 --> 00:12:12.720 And as a student, you would get a discount as well.

- 00:12:12.820 --> 00:12:14.720 I think at the moment it's three pounds a month.

- 00:12:14.760 --> 00:12:17.280 So it might be worth checking out if you do a lot of presentations.

- 00:12:18.260 --> 00:12:22.820 And alternatively, you can always use PowerPoints, which if you don't have it,

- 00:12:23.000 --> 00:12:28.200 you can download it for free as well as the whole Microsoft Office package from this website here.

- 00:12:28.880 --> 00:12:35.160 You can also just Google LSE Microsoft Office free and then you can find the website and download that.

- 00:12:35.340 --> 00:12:36.400 That's free for every student.

- 00:12:38.340 --> 00:12:43.140 As a final note for all presentations, I really think that practice is the key.

- 00:12:43.140 --> 00:12:49.380 So as much practice as you can do is the best situation for this.

- 00:12:49.680 --> 00:12:57.760 So I think that many presentations are completed quite quickly and last minute people underestimate how important and how difficult they actually are.

- 00:12:57.760 --> 00:13:04.660 So if you can finish it earlier and then rehearse as much as you can, it will really help you to get more feedback from friends.

- 00:13:05.080 --> 00:13:07.420 It's going to make you much more confident on the day.

- 00:13:07.620 --> 00:13:11.740 And also your presentation is, you know, going to be much smoother.

- 00:13:12.720 --> 00:13:16.640 So that's it for this video. Good luck with your presenting and I hope I see you soon.